Annual Report of the Parochial Church Council for the Year Ended 31 December 2026

Presented to the Annual Parochial Church Meeting on 25 April 2027

Aims and Purposes

The Parochial Church Council works with the incumbent in promoting the whole mission of the Church in the parish, pastoral, evangelistic, social and ecumenical. It is also responsible for the maintenance of the church building and for the parish's finances.

Worship and Ministry

Holy Trinity held 312 services during the year, including a weekly said service in the care home on Mill Lane. Average Sunday attendance rose from 86 to 94 adults, with between 15 and 25 children at the monthly family service. The Easter and Christmas services were again the best attended of the year.

Occasion	2025	2026
Baptisms	11	14
Confirmations	6	4
Weddings	5	7
Funerals	19	16

Mission and Outreach

The council gave 10 per cent of its unrestricted income to mission, divided as follows:

- Ashcombe Vale Food Bank, which the church also hosts on Tuesday mornings;
- the diocesan partnership supporting two rural schools;
- a winter night shelter run jointly with the other churches of the town.

Buildings and Churchyard

The repair of the north aisle roof was completed in September, two weeks ahead of schedule and within budget. The quinquennial inspection is due in 2027. The churchyard volunteers met monthly and planted a new hedge along the eastern boundary.

Financial Review

Total income for the year was £148,730, of which £41,200 was given for the roof appeal and is held as a restricted fund. The summary below is taken from the independently examined accounts.

	Funds 2026			
	Unrestricted	**Restricted**	**Total 2026**	**Total 2025**
Income				
Planned giving	61,420	—	61,420	58,960
Collections and donations	18,350	41,200	59,550	24,110
Gift Aid recovered	15,380	2,150	17,530	15,240
Hall lettings and fees	10,230	—	10,230	9,870
Total income	**105,380**	**43,350**	**148,730**	**108,180**
Expenditure				
Parish share	58,000	—	58,000	56,500
Mission giving	10,540	—	10,540	9,990
Building repairs	6,210	47,980	54,190	7,430
Running costs	24,870	—	24,870	23,640
Total expenditure	**99,620**	**47,980**	**147,600**	**97,560**
Net income / (expenditure)	**5,760**	**(4,630)**	**1,130**	**10,620**

The restricted deficit was met from the roof fund balance brought forward from 2025.

Reserves Policy

The council's policy is to hold unrestricted reserves:

(i) equal to at least three months of unrestricted expenditure, currently about £25,000; and

(ii) a further £10,000 for urgent repairs not covered by insurance.

At the end of the year unrestricted reserves stood at £38,940, which meets this policy.

Approval

This report was approved by the Parochial Church Council on 14 March 2027 and signed on its behalf by:

The Revd Canon Miriam Oduya-Thwaite, Vicar and Chair
Mr Peter Lindqvist-Hale, Treasurer